

Steven Le

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EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Barbara (GPA: 3.68)

Expected Graduation: June 2027

Bachelors of Science, Environmental Studies (BS) + Earth Science Minor

- Foundations of Agile Project Management Professional Certificate (March 2026 - March 2027).
- Relevant Coursework: GIS for Environmental Apps, Stats for Environmental Science, Intro to MATLAB (in progress), Environmental Impact Analysis (in progress), Sustainable Communities, Agile Approaches to Project Management (in progress).
- FUERTE Fellow (Field-based Undergraduate Engagement through Research, Teaching, and Education).
 - PI: Gretchen Hofmann.
- Bren-Environmental Studies Fellow.
- UC Santa Barbara Presidential Scholarship Recipient.

WORK EXPERIENCE

UC Santa Barbara Sustainability

June 2026 - Present

Bike Storage, Pilot Program Intern

- Developing (currently) a grant proposal for the implementation of enclosed bike cages on campus using UCSB's transportation data, analyzing different forms of active bike storage on campus + possible bike cages that could work for e-bikes/long-distance commuters, and by going out to different locations that are feasible for cages.
- Evaluated data from UCSB's annual Transportation Survey and Summer 2025 Graduate Student Secure Bike Storage Survey to determine biking population, campus bike safety/security, bike infrastructure and commuting priorities.
- Communicated with people from different UCSB departments to understand the best options for bike cages, rules/regulations to new campus structures, and awareness of bike locker storage options on campus.

Ecosystem Ecology and Biogeochemistry Lab

July 2026 - Present: Santa Barbara, CA

Undergraduate Research Assistant

- Assisted with data collection of pyrogenic carbon (charcoal) accumulation in soil (2 samples for different analyzers and 1 sample for bulk density per site) at 25+ different sites in Sedgwick Reserve.
- Performed pH analysis of 30+ fine-grained soil samples, measured out different soil masses into samples to be used for other analyzers, and crushed/sifted soil samples directly from the site.

Landscape Ecophysiology And Function Lab

April 2025 - May 2026: Santa Barbara, CA

Undergraduate Researcher

- Conducted fieldwork on three separate trips to the Sierra Nevadas in order to measure the composition of conifer regeneration and community composition at post-fire sites at four different severities (low, moderate, moderate-high, high) along with measuring shrub cover, soil moisture and temperature, sunlight, and Leaf Area Index (LAI).
- Recorded leaf samples from previous trips to the Sedgwick Reserve, measuring leaf wet mass, stem wet mass, diameter, and length before scanning leaves.
- Gathered fieldwork data from our ecological community transects, seedlings, and TDR.

Your Children's Trees at UCSB

Jan. 2024 - May 2025

Urban Forestry Restoration Intern

- Assisted in tree-planting at growing grounds and forest restoration events in UC Santa Barbara, Ellwood Mesa, and Elings Park on a weekly basis in all weather conditions to reinvigorate the health of local natural environments.
- Developed outdoor technical skills both in measuring trees' height & circumference and mapping their campus locations, created a map of UCSB campus walks for children.

- Educated and advocated for tree conservation to hundreds of students during science nights at local K-12 schools on multiple weekdays throughout Santa Barbara County.

PROJECTS

Coastal Erosion Along Central and Southern California

April 2026 - June 2026: Santa Barbara, CA

ENV S 154: GIS for Environmental Applications

- Applied GIS skills to a quarter-long group project that answered our research question pertaining to natural hazards and climate impacts: Where along California's Central to Southern coastline is erosion most severe? Furthermore, how does it spatio-temporally correlate with runoff and wind patterns?
- Obtained GIS data layers for watersheds, cliff erosion, runoff, and wind speed from online open sources, converted them onto one map that showed average rainfall, wind speed, and cliff erosion for each watershed zone, and evaluated the data visually by creating scatterplots for overall runoff and wind speed relative to cliff erosion, respectively, and presented information as a story map to the course professor and peers.

Leaf Angle and Water Availability

Oct. 2025 - May 2026: Santa Barbara, CA

Landscape Ecophysiology And Function Lab

- Developed and presented a research poster that quantifies leaf angles and tests the hypothesis that changes in leaf angles mediate the impacts of low water availability, using photos taken of blue oak (*quercus douglasii*) and coast live oak (*quercus agrifolia*) from Sedgwick Reserve, recording data from the azimuth and pitch of those photos taken along with the angles of the leaves (related to straight line and z-axis), and comparing it to the lab's existing database of water potential measurements for the trees from the driest periods (July in 2022-23, 2025).

SKILLS

- ArcGIS Pro, RStudio, ImageJ, labwork (measuring, sorting, and scanning seeds/leaves), fieldwork (conducted transects/quadrats, identification knowledge of conifer, non-native, and vegetation species in the Sierra Nevadas), tree preservation and measuring, project management, Vietnamese (limited working proficiency).

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Unified Program Agency: CUPA 101, Hazmat Cleanup for Dummies, Pollution and Climate Mapping: CalHeatScore and CalEnviroScreen, Lessons Learned from Common HMBP & HW CUPA Inspection Violations.